

# Shalom Catholic Community

Feeding the homeless - April 11, 2025

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## **Bay Street**

*Bay street is Toronto's financial district.*

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### **CRYSTAL & DAVID**

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**W**e found Crystal sitting in front of a Rabba mart. She was older and slightly heavy set with a bludging scar on her lip. She was a well spoken woman with sad eyes and a gentle demeanor. Her first response when offered the food was to say thank you and ask if I had another for her husband. She said his name was 'David.' I told her we would pray for both her and her husband.

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### **JP**

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**J**P was sleeping on a vent in front of the TD bank across from city hall. He smelled a little of urine. He was huddled up in blankets so as to try and fight off the cold. He was tall, young, and looked at me with eyes that had a strange innocence. I saw surprise and gratitude in them.

JP had a stutter and it was hard for him to get his words out. He stuttered thank yous struggling to express how grateful he was. There was a kindness to JP that you could see in his face and hear in his speech. I told him we would pray for him.

# Union Station

*Union station is Toronto's transport hub*

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## **CHRIS**

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Chris was curled up near union station. He had a black and white dog that looked like a collie. The dog would have been cute but it looked at me scared like it was afraid I was going to hurt it. Chris looked at me with this pained expression on his face. It was an expression of agony and destitution. Still he thanked me for the food and gave me his name before quickly curling back up with his dog.

Chris was very young. He looked like he was in his early 20s. He had light blond hair, a pleasant face, and gentle features that made his agonized expression all the more painful.

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## **DAVID**

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We found David sitting under a bridge near union station. He was just staring at the concrete wall across the street from him. He looked zoned out. He didn't look at me when I spoke to him but still answered "yes" he would like the food and gave me his name. I left him staring at the wall.

# Peter Street

*Peter street has a homeless shelter near it.*

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## **TANYA & ROB**

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I saw Tanya and Rob by the entrance to a building. Tanya was very quiet, she accepted the food with a thank you. Her partner Rob was an older man with a bald head and a nice smile. He was very friendly. He told me a little about the area. He said he liked me and gave me a hug. He wanted to know about Shalom so he could thank you for the food.

Rob told me that he wasn't religious but that ever since his mom died he became spiritual. He said he was smoking some stuff from a pipe after his mom's death and some strange force came and smacked the pipe from his hands.

Their friend came while I was talking to them. Rob told me he wanted to share his meal with his friend and he seemed so happy that he had something to share. He had that spirit of generosity. Rob seemed to be full of love and joy.

# Yonge and Wellesley

*There is an emergency shelter near Young and Wellesley*

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## **KANE**

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Kane was sitting near young and Wellesley. His hands were cold, blued and puffy. There was something about his appearance that made me suspect he had a genetic birth defect. As soon as I gave him the food he offered me a wrapped chocolate bar in return. I turned him down because I didn't like the idea of taking food from someone in his situation. What I remember about Kane is he seemed unsophisticated but also full of love.

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## **RAMON**

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Ramon was sitting near Kane scratching a scratch and win. He didn't say much. He just accepted the food, gave me his name with a slight smile and went back to scratching his ticket.